Don Yuen

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I'm a computer science graduate from Queens College working toward AI engineering. I built a Claude API app and measured its output with a rubric and a panel of model judges, and I wrote a NumPy neural network from scratch with an AI coding assistant. Before that, I spent five years in hands-on tech support at Best Buy and Geek Squad, diagnosing problems for 15 to 25 clients a day.

SKILLS

- Languages: Python, JavaScript, TypeScript, Java, SQL
- AI and machine learning: Claude API (structured outputs), prompt design, LLM evaluation with rubrics and model judges, NumPy, backpropagation, gradient checking
- Frameworks and tools: Node.js, Astro, React, Git, GitHub Actions, Vitest, Playwright, node:test, AI coding assistants
- Practices: writing specs for AI-assisted builds, reviewing and testing AI-written code, unit and end-to-end tests, error analysis
- Hardware: through-hole soldering, basic PCB design in Multisim and Ultiboard, LabVIEW, 8088 and Arduino programming
- IT support: Windows and macOS, system imaging, basic networking (IP, DNS, Wi-Fi), Office 365, Google Workspace
- Spoken languages: English, Cantonese, Mandarin

PROJECTS

Historic Photo Explorer

Node.js, Claude API, Library of Congress API · Project page · GitHub

- Built a Node.js app that finds Library of Congress photos and uses the Claude API to describe them for blind and low-vision readers.
- Raised the accuracy score from 4.45 to 4.90 out of 5 on a 20-photo rubric by adding low-resolution image detection and a stricter prompt. On 150 px thumbnails, accuracy rose from 3.4 to 4.6.
- Scored descriptions on 4 criteria with 4 model judges, then hand-checked the 40 scores where they differed by 2+ points.
- Used only Node.js core modules, requested JSON-schema structured outputs, and escaped all model output.

MNIST Neural Network from Scratch

Python, NumPy · Project page · GitHub

- Built a 784-128-64-10 ReLU network in NumPy with no ML framework, working with an AI coding assistant while deriving backpropagation by hand.
- Verified the hand-derived gradients against centered finite differences, with a relative error of about 1e-9.
- Reached 98.32% accuracy on the 10,000-image MNIST test set, used once after tuning on a separate validation set.
- Swept learning rate, width, and batch size over 3 seeds, which exposed a learning rate that fell to about 12% on one seed.

EXPERIENCE

Store Manager, Fuzzy Paws Tavern

May 2024 – May 2025 · Queens, NY

- Managed daily operations for a pet grooming and boarding boutique and led 1 full-time and 2 part-time staff.
- Expanded the store's capacity for large dogs, a premium service that brought in 15 to 20 percent of total revenue.
- Ran the store's CRM and back-end systems, including client records and appointment history.
- Standardized service procedures and client communications, and resolved client escalations.

Consultation Agent, Geek Squad (Best Buy)

Aug 2019 – Jan 2024 · New York, NY · Part-time, then full-time for the final 6 months

- Diagnosed hardware and software problems for 15 to 25 clients a day from client reports and hands-on testing.
- Repaired devices, including component swaps and soldering, and logged precise service orders in Apple GSX and NOVA.
- Troubleshot VPN and network problems, and helped clients spot scams and recover after being scammed.
- Trained 4 to 6 new hires and handled escalated client concerns under time pressure.

Sales Associate (Computers), Best Buy

Jul 2018 – Aug 2019 · New York, NY

- Advised customers on hardware specs and system requirements and matched them to the right products.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science, Queens College (CUNY)

Jan 2024 – Aug 2026 · Queens, NY

Relevant coursework: Database Systems, Data Structures and Algorithms, Deep Learning and Systems

Associate in Applied Science, Computer Engineering Technology, Queensborough Community College (CUNY)

Aug 2020 – Jan 2023 · Queens, NY

CERTIFICATIONS

- Apple Certified iOS Technician (ACiT), Apple, 2019
- Apple Service Fundamentals, Apple, 2019